

GUIDE 1 OF 4

Master Guide

2025–2026 Edition · All Programs · All Counties

Every New Jersey property tax relief program in one place.

ANCHOR · Stay NJ · Senior Freeze · Veterans Benefits · Tax Appeals

Updated for the 2025 benefit year and the 2026 filing season.

Covers Camden, Gloucester, and Burlington Counties.

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This guide is for informational purposes only. It does not constitute legal or tax advice. Program rules, deadlines, and benefit amounts change annually. Always verify current information at nj.gov or by calling 1-888-238-1233 before filing.

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Understanding NJ Property Taxes

The basics every homeowner and renter should know

New Jersey consistently ranks among the highest property tax states in the country. The average NJ homeowner pays over \$9,000 per year — more than double the national average. What many residents do not realize is that the State of New Jersey funds several programs specifically designed to offset this burden. These are not obscure benefits. They are funded annually, actively promoted by the NJ Division of Taxation, and available to hundreds of thousands of households. Yet a significant portion of eligible residents never apply — often because the process feels complicated.

This guide exists to fix that. Every major program is explained in plain language, with exact income thresholds, deadlines, and instructions for South Jersey residents in Camden, Gloucester, and Burlington Counties.

How NJ Property Taxes Are Calculated

Your annual property tax bill is calculated by multiplying your assessed value by your municipality's tax rate. The assessed value is set by your local tax assessor and is supposed to reflect a percentage of your home's true market value, known as the **equalization ratio**. This ratio varies by town and changes annually.

Formula: **Assessed Value × Tax Rate = Annual Tax Bill**

Example: \$250,000 assessed value × 3.2% rate = \$8,000 annual tax

Programs Available to NJ Residents

Program	Who Qualifies	Maximum Benefit	Deadline
ANCHOR	All homeowners & renters	\$1,500	Non-senior: Aug 2026
Stay NJ	Age 65+, income ≤\$500K	\$6,500/yr	PAS-1 by Nov 2, 2026
Senior Freeze	Age 65+ or disabled	Varies	PAS-1 by Nov 2, 2026
Veterans Deduction	Eligible veterans	\$250/yr	One-time at assessor
100% Exemption	Disabled veterans	Full exemption	One-time at assessor
Tax Appeal	All property owners	Varies	April 1 most counties

■ Important

Benefit amounts and income thresholds change each year. Always verify current figures at nj.gov or by calling 1-888-238-1233 before filing your application.

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ANCHOR Program

Affordable NJ Communities for Homeowners and Renters

ANCHOR replaced the Homestead Benefit program and significantly expanded eligibility. Unlike the old Homestead Benefit, ANCHOR includes **renters** — not just homeowners. Benefits are paid as direct deposits or checks, not as credits on your tax bill.

Who Qualifies

Category	Income Limit	Benefit Amount	Notes
Homeowner (under 65)	≤ \$150,000	\$1,500	Primary residence on Oct 1
Homeowner (under 65)	\$150,001–\$250,000	\$1,000	Primary residence on Oct 1
Homeowner (65+)	≤ \$150,000	\$1,750	File PAS-1, not ANC-1
Homeowner (65+)	\$150,001–\$250,000	\$1,250	File PAS-1, not ANC-1
Renter (under 65)	≤ \$150,000	\$450	Must have paid rent
Renter (65+)	≤ \$150,000	\$700	File PAS-1, not ANC-1
Over income limits	Any	\$0	Does not qualify

ANCHOR Eligibility Requirements

- **Primary residence** — The property must have been your main NJ home on October 1 of the benefit year.
- **Income threshold** — Total gross income from all sources must be within limits. This includes wages, Social Security, pensions, rental income, and investment returns.
- **Property taxes current** — Homeowners more than 12 months delinquent on property taxes may be disqualified.
- **No second home exception** — You cannot claim ANCHOR on a vacation home or investment property.
- **One application per household** — Married couples file one application jointly.

What Counts as Income for ANCHOR?

This is the most common point of confusion. ANCHOR uses **gross income** — before any deductions. The following all count:

- Wages, salaries, and tips from all jobs
- Social Security benefits (including disability)
- Pension and annuity payments
- IRA and 401(k) distributions

- Net rental income from other properties
- Dividends, interest, and capital gains
- Alimony received
- Business income (net)

How to Apply

Non-seniors (under 65): Apply online at anchor.nj.gov or call 1-888-238-1233. You will need your NJ driver's license or ID, Social Security number, and your block and lot number (on your property tax bill).

Seniors (65+): Do NOT use the ANC-1 form. Use the PAS-1 combined application (see Section 6). The PAS-1 covers ANCHOR, Stay NJ, and Senior Freeze in one form. Filing the wrong form can delay your benefit.

ANCHOR Hotline

1-888-238-1233 · Monday–Friday 8:30am–5:30pm

Online: anchor.nj.gov · File at: propertytaxrelief.nj.gov (seniors)

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Stay NJ Program

50% off your annual property tax bill — new for 2026

The Stay NJ Act was signed into law in June 2023 and represents the largest senior property tax relief expansion in New Jersey history. For qualifying seniors, it provides a credit equal to **50% of their annual property tax bill**, up to a maximum of **\$6,500 per year**, paid in quarterly installments.

Eligibility Requirements

Requirement	Detail
Age	65 or older during the benefit year
Residency	NJ homeowner — primary residence only
Income Limit	Household income ≤ \$500,000 (all sources)
Property Taxes	Must be current (not more than 12 months delinquent)
Application	PAS-1 combined form — by November 2, 2026
Payment Schedule	Quarterly: February, May, August, November

How the Credit Is Calculated

Stay NJ credit = 50% × Annual Property Tax Bill (maximum \$6,500/year).

Annual Tax Bill	Stay NJ Credit (50%)	Net Tax After Credit
\$6,000	\$3,000	\$3,000
\$8,000	\$4,000	\$4,000
\$10,000	\$5,000	\$5,000
\$13,000	\$6,500 (maximum)	\$6,500
\$16,000	\$6,500 (capped)	\$9,500

Quarterly Payment Schedule

Stay NJ is paid in four equal installments each year. For a \$4,000 annual credit, you receive \$1,000 four times per year. Payments began February 2026.

Stay NJ + ANCHOR: You Can Get Both

A senior who qualifies for both ANCHOR (\$1,750) and Stay NJ (up to \$6,500) can receive both benefits. They are not mutually exclusive. The PAS-1 form applies for both simultaneously.

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Senior Freeze (PTR)
Property Tax Reimbursement — freeze your base year tax

The Senior Freeze, officially called the Property Tax Reimbursement (PTR) program, reimburses eligible seniors for every dollar their property taxes increase above a "base year" amount. Once enrolled, your effective tax burden is frozen — the State pays the difference between what you owe now and what you owed in your base year.

Eligibility Requirements

Requirement	Threshold/Detail
Age	65+ or receiving Social Security Disability / Railroad Retirement Disability
NJ Residency	Must have lived in NJ for at least 10 consecutive years
Current Home	Must have owned and lived in current home at least 3 years
Income (2024)	≤ \$150,000 (verify current year limit at nj.gov)
Income (2025)	≤ \$172,475 (2025 benefit year)
Tax Status	Property taxes must be paid in full — no delinquency allowed

■ Income Limit Changes

The Senior Freeze income limit increases slightly each year. Always verify the current year limit at nj.gov/treasury/taxation/ptr before assuming you do or do not qualify.

How Reimbursement Works

Your "base year" is the year you first qualified and filed. After that, the State reimburses you for any increase above that base year amount. Example: if your base year taxes were \$6,000 and your current year taxes are \$7,200, the State sends you a check for \$1,200.

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Veterans Property Tax Benefits

\$250 annual deduction and 100% exemption for disabled veterans

New Jersey offers two distinct property tax benefits for veterans: a \$250 annual deduction available to most eligible veterans, and a full 100% property tax exemption for veterans with a 100% service-connected disability rating.

\$250 Veterans Deduction

- Honorably discharged from active service in the U.S. Armed Forces
- Served during a qualifying period of wartime or emergency (check nj.gov for full list)
- NJ resident and homeowner
- Apply once at your municipal tax assessor's office — benefit renews automatically
- Document needed: DD-214 Certificate of Release or Discharge from Active Duty

100% Disability Exemption

Veterans with a **100% permanent and total service-connected disability** rating from the VA may qualify for a **complete property tax exemption** — meaning \$0 in annual property taxes. This is among the most generous veterans benefits in the country.

Surviving Spouse Benefits

The surviving spouse of a veteran who received the \$250 deduction or the disability exemption may continue to receive the benefit after the veteran's passing, provided they have not remarried and remain in the same home.

Where to Apply

Apply at your municipal tax assessor's office — not through the State.

Bring your DD-214 and VA disability rating letter (for exemption).

The deduction is applied annually to your tax bill automatically once approved.

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PAS-1 Combined Application

One form — three programs — for seniors 65+ and disabled homeowners

The PAS-1 form is the most important document in NJ senior property tax relief. It is a single application that simultaneously applies for ANCHOR, Stay NJ, and Senior Freeze (PTR). Seniors 65+ should **never** use the ANC-1 form — doing so means missing out on Stay NJ and PTR.

Who Must Use the PAS-1

- All NJ homeowners age 65 or older
- Homeowners receiving Social Security Disability Insurance (SSDI)
- Homeowners receiving Railroad Retirement Board disability benefits

2026 Deadline: November 2, 2026

■ Hard Deadline

The PAS-1 deadline is November 2, 2026 for the 2025 benefit year. Missing this date means waiting an entire year to refile. There are no extensions. Start early.

What You Need to File

NJ Tax Returns	Most recent year's NJ-1040 for income verification
Social Security Statement	Form SSA-1099 showing annual benefit amount
Property Tax Bill	Current year bill with block and lot number
Photo ID	NJ driver's license or state ID
Bank Account Info	For direct deposit of benefit payments
Pension Statements	1099-R for any pension or annuity income

File at: propertytaxrelief.nj.gov · Or call: 1-888-238-1233

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Property Tax Appeals

Your right to challenge your assessment — every year

Every NJ property owner has the right to appeal their property tax assessment annually. A successful appeal permanently reduces your assessed value, lowering your taxes every year going forward — not just once.

When an Appeal Makes Sense

- Your assessed value divided by the equalization ratio is significantly higher than what comparable homes are selling for
- Your home has deferred maintenance, functional issues, or condition problems not reflected in the assessment
- Your assessment increased dramatically in a year when market values in your area did not
- You recently purchased your home for less than its assessed implied market value
- You can find at least 3 comparable sales ("comps") that support a lower value

County Appeal Contacts

County	Board Address	Phone	Deadline
Camden	520 Market St, Suite 3075, Camden NJ 08102	(856) 225-5238	April 1
Gloucester	2 S. Broad St, Woodbury NJ 08096	(856) 853-3440	April 1
Burlington	49 Rancocas Rd, Mt Holly NJ 08060	(609) 265-5327	April 1

Free MLS Comps for Your Appeal

John Scafide can pull comparable MLS sales for any South Jersey property at no cost — the same data the Tax Board uses. Contact: NJPropertyTaxRelief.com

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County Quick Reference

Camden, Gloucester, and Burlington Counties

Camden County

37 municipalities including Cherry Hill, Voorhees, Haddon Township, Collingswood, Gloucester Township, Pennsauken, Winslow Township, and Lindenwold. County seat: Camden. Board of Taxation: (856) 225-5238.

Gloucester County

24 municipalities including Washington Township, Deptford, Monroe Township, West Deptford, Woolwich Township, Mantua, and Woodbury. County seat: Woodbury. Board of Taxation: (856) 853-3440.

Burlington County

40 municipalities — NJ's largest county by land area. Includes Mount Laurel, Evesham (Marlton), Moorestown, Medford, Cinnaminson, Delran, and Maple Shade. County seat: Mount Holly. Board of Taxation: (609) 265-5327.

9 Key Deadlines Calendar — 2026

Date	Deadline / Event	Who It Affects
Jan–Feb 2026	Assessment notices mailed by municipalities	All property owners
Feb 2026	First Stay NJ quarterly payment distributed	Seniors 65+
Apr 1, 2026	Property tax appeal deadline (most counties)	All property owners
May 2026	Second Stay NJ quarterly payment	Seniors 65+
Aug 2026	ANCHOR auto-confirmation letters (non-seniors)	Homeowners/Renters <65
Aug 2026	Third Stay NJ quarterly payment	Seniors 65+
Nov 2, 2026	PAS-1 filing deadline (ANCHOR + Stay NJ + Freeze)	Seniors 65+ / Disabled
Nov 2026	Fourth Stay NJ quarterly payment	Seniors 65+
Oct 1	Key ANCHOR residency date (each year)	All applicants

■ Missed Deadline = Wait One Year

All these deadlines are firm. There are no grace periods or extensions for the PAS-1 or property tax appeals. Mark your calendar now.

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Glossary

Terms every NJ homeowner and taxpayer should know

Assessed Value	The dollar value assigned to your property by your municipal tax assessor. This is the number your tax bill is calculated from.
Equalization Ratio	The percentage at which a municipality assesses properties relative to true market value. Set annually by the NJ Division of Taxation.
True Market Value / Implied Value	$\text{Assessed Value} \div \text{Equalization Ratio}$. This is what the county believes your home is actually worth.
Base Year (PTR)	The first year you qualified for Senior Freeze. Your taxes are compared to this year to calculate your reimbursement.
Block & Lot	Your property's unique tax map identifier. Found on your property tax bill and deed. Required for ANCHOR and PAS-1 applications.
Gross Income	Total income before any deductions — wages, Social Security, pensions, interest, dividends, and more. Used to determine program eligibility.
DD-214	Certificate of Release or Discharge from Active Duty. Required to apply for the Veterans \$250 deduction or disability exemption.
PAS-1	The NJ combined senior/disabled application that covers ANCHOR, Stay NJ, and Senior Freeze in one form.
ANC-1	The standard ANCHOR application for non-seniors. Seniors 65+ should NOT use this form — use PAS-1 instead.
Comparable Sales (Comps)	Recent sales of similar nearby properties used as evidence in a property tax appeal.

Need Help?

NJPropertyTaxRelief.com · @thetaxwatchdog on TikTok

PAS-1 Filing Help: \$20 flat fee · Book at NJPropertyTaxRelief.com

Free MLS Comps for Tax Appeals · Free Real Estate Consultations

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